

Define test tasks

Task 1: Improve an academic argument by identifying weaknesses and revising it before submission.

Tasks 2: Strengthen a draft by addressing potential bias and opposing viewpoints.

Task 3: Review past progress to see whether argument confidence has improved over time.

Run usability tests (Used screen for this)

Task 1 Observations: **Improve an academic argument by identifying weaknesses and revising it before submission.**

Homepage: Tester paused at “Start Session” and asked what it meant. They spent time deciding whether to click Start Session or Log In.

Clicked Start Session first.

On New Session, they hovered between Paste Text and Start Blank.

New Session: They said “Paste Text and Start Blank sound like the same thing,” and weren’t sure which one matched “starting an argument.”

No major dead ends, but there was a brief “stall” on New Session due to unclear option differences.

Most time was spent on the Homepage decision and New Session choice.

Task 2 Observations: **Strengthen a draft by addressing potential bias and opposing viewpoints.**

Workspace: Tester immediately clicked the tabs (Bias / Fallacy / Opposition) before using Run Challenge.

I expected them to click Run Challenge first, but they assumed the tabs already contained results.

When tabs didn’t “change anything,” tester said: “I expected something to show up here automatically.”

The tester treated the tabs like navigation that should instantly populate information.

They clicked between tabs multiple times before noticing the Run Challenge button.

Tester expected a “guidance” message like: “Run Challenge to generate results” inside the tab area.

Tasks 3 Observations: **Review past progress to see whether argument confidence has improved over time.**

Recap page: Tester saw “View Progress” and understood it, but asked what “Progress” would include.

Progress page: Tester saw the trend summary but asked: “What is this line measuring?” They expected a label like “Confidence Score over time.”

No wrong turns; they could navigate, but interpretation of the trend was unclear.

Low time navigating; probably would spend more time understanding trend

Collecting Feedback

1. What felt confusing?

Direct Quotes:

- “I wasn’t totally sure what ‘Start Session’ meant at first.”
- “Paste Text and Start Blank feel kind of the same.”
- “I clicked the tabs because I thought results would already be there.”

Summary of Confusion:

- Some button labels were unclear.
- The difference between session options was not obvious.
- Tabs suggested content existed before running the challenge.
- The trend summary lacked context or labeling.

2. What felt easy?

Direct Quotes:

- “The flow makes sense.”
- “It’s pretty straightforward once you start.”
- “The buttons are where I expected them to be.”
- “It’s not overwhelming.”

Summary of What Worked Well:

- Linear structure was intuitive.
- The design felt clean and uncluttered.
- The session flow (workspace → results → recap) felt logical.
- Clear primary action buttons helped guide navigation.

3. What felt slow or frustrating?

Direct Quotes:

- “I had to pause to think about what to click next.”
- “I expected something to happen when I clicked the tabs.”
- “I wanted a little explanation about what I was looking at.”

Summary of Frustration Points:

- Minor hesitation at decision points (Homepage and New Session).
- Lack of system feedback in Workspace.
- Unclear labeling on Progress metrics.

4. What did you expect to happen that didn't?

Direct Quotes:

- “I expected the Bias tab to already have something in it.”
- “I thought the graph would say what it was tracking.”
- “I expected some kind of hint telling me to run the challenge first.”

Key Insight:

The tester expected:

- Immediate content in tabs.
- Clear labels on data visualizations.
- Small instructional cues.

If you could change something, what would you change?

Direct Quote:

- “I'd add small explanations so I don't have to guess what things mean.”

Additional comment:

- “The design is simple, which is good — it just needs slightly clearer wording.”

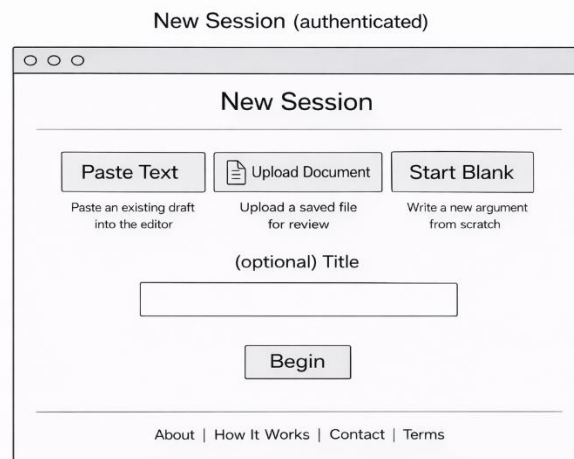
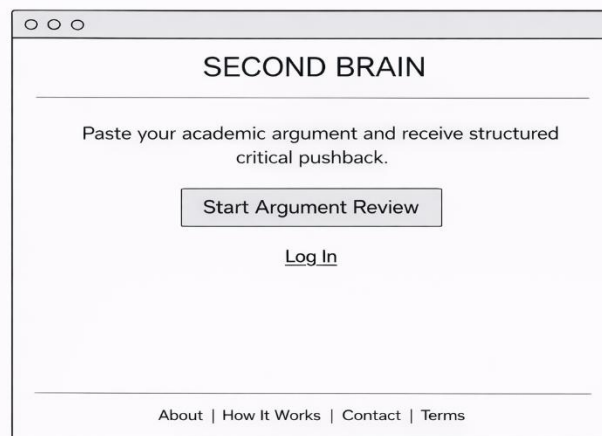
Patterns

1. **Homepage Clarity;** Hesitation at Start Session
2. **New Session Options;** Difference between paste text and start blank
3. **Workspace tabs;** clicked tabs before running challenge thinking results would be there
4. **Progress Page Metrics;** wondered what the graph would present

Analyze and Improve

The three issues I'll focus on are from above: homepage clarity, new session options, and workspace tabs.

1. **Homepage Clarity;** Change "Start Session" to "Start Argument Review"
2. **New Session Options;** Input explanations under titles: Paste Text (paste an existing draft into the editor), Upload Document (Upload a saved file for review), Start Blank (Write a new argument from scratch)
3. **Workspace tabs;** Explain on the page "Run challenge to generate analysis"



Workspace

Run Challenge to Generate Analysis

Bias

Fallacy

Opposition

End Session